

Theme: Comprehension

Date:

Class: SS 1

Time:

Period

Duration:

Subject: English Language

Unit Topic: Comprehension Skills

Lesson Topic: Reading a Passage for Word Meanings

Specific (Behavioural) Objectives

At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

1. read a comprehension passage fluently, and identify unfamiliar words in a passage,
2. use contextual clues to determine the meanings of words,
3. give synonyms of selected words from a passage,
4. use the words correctly in sentences.

Instructional Resources

- Comprehension passage from New Oxford Secondary English Course for Senior Secondary Schools, Book 1
- English dictionary
- /Whiteboard
- Marker.

LESSON PRESENTATION

Step 1: IDENTIFICATION OF PRIOR IDEAS

Mode: Individual

Teacher's Activities

Teacher asks students:

1. What do you do when you come across a difficult word while reading?
2. Can the meaning of a word be guessed from the sentence in which it appears?
3. What is context?
4. Why is it important to understand the meanings of words in a passage?

Students' Activities

Students respond based on their experiences in reading comprehension passages.

Step 2: EXPLORATION

Mode: Entire Class

Teacher's Activities

Teacher explains that comprehension involves understanding a passage and determining the meanings of words from the context in which they are used.

What is Context?

Context refers to the words, phrases, and sentences surrounding a word that help the reader determine its meaning.

Ways of Determining Word Meanings in a Passage

1. Using context clues.
2. Looking for synonyms in nearby sentences.
3. Looking for antonyms or contrasts.
4. Studying examples given in the passage.
5. Using prior knowledge.
6. Consulting a dictionary where necessary.

Students' Activities

Students listen attentively, ask questions, and take notes.

Step 3: DISCUSSION

Mode: Entire Class

Teacher's Activities

Teacher directs students to a selected comprehension passage from New Oxford Secondary English Course for Senior Secondary Schools, Book 1.

The teacher:

Reads the passage aloud while students follow.

Invites students to read portions of the passage.

Guides students to identify unfamiliar words.

Leads discussion on how contextual clues help reveal meanings.

Explains selected vocabulary items from the passage.

Illustrative Examples

Teacher may use the following examples to demonstrate how context helps in determining word meanings:

Passage Extract:

Ade is a very diligent student. He studies regularly and completes all his assignments on time. Because of his hard work, he has become one of the

most outstanding students in his school. His teachers often commend him for his excellent performance. Although some students find their studies tedious, Ade remains focused and determined. His success has become a source of inspiration to his classmates.

Word

Meaning from Context

Synonym

Diligent

Hardworking

Industrious

Outstanding

Excellent; exceptional

Remarkable

Commend

Praise

Applaud

Tedious

Boring; tiresome

Monotonous

Inspiration

Something that motivates

Encouragement

Additional Vocabulary Practice

Word

Meaning

Synonym

Prosperity

Wealth and success

Affluence

Courage

Bravery

Boldness

Generous

Willing to give

Kind-hearted

Scarcity

Shortage

Lack

Abundant

More than enough

Plentiful

Honest

Truthful

Sincere

Fragile

Easily broken

Delicate

Ancient

Very old

Antique

Efficient

Productive and effective

Competent

Ambition

Strong desire to succeed

Aspiration

Students' Activities

Students:

Read the passage silently and aloud.

Identify unfamiliar words.

Infer meanings from context.

Suggest synonyms.

Use selected words in sentences.

Step 4: APPLICATION

Mode: Entire Class

Teacher's Activities

Class Activity

Using the selected passage from New Oxford Secondary English Course,
Book 1:

List five unfamiliar words from the passage.

State their meanings as used in the passage.

Give a synonym for each word.

Use any three of the words in meaningful sentences.

Students' Activities

Students carry out the activity individually and compare answers with
classmates.

Step 5: EVALUATION

Mode: A Couple of Students

Teacher's Activities

Teacher asks students:

1. What is context?
2. Mention three ways of determining word meanings in a passage.
3. Explain the meanings of selected words from the passage read.
4. State the contextual clues that helped you determine the meanings.

Students' Activities

Students respond orally and in writing.

ASSIGNMENT

From the selected passage in New Oxford Secondary English Course for Senior Secondary Schools, Book 1:

Identify ten unfamiliar words.

Give their meanings as used in the passage.

Provide a synonym for each word.

Use each word in a meaningful sentence.

REFERENCE MATERIALS

F. Ademola-Adeoye et al. (2012). New Concept English for Senior Secondary Schools, Book 1. Learn Africa Plc, Lagos.

New Oxford Secondary English Course for Senior Secondary Schools,
Book 1.

Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary.

WAEC and NECO Recommended English Language Textbooks.

Comprehensive English Language Textbooks.